

上智大学 外国語学部 英語学科 英 語 自習プリント

英語が得意な人のための「私大難関本番レベル」— 消えゆく言語を読み解く

2026 年 5 月 26 日

高校 3 年～既卒 (難関私大文系志望)

英語 (上智 外国語学部 英語学科・本番水準)

Trillion 塾

第1章 (例題 — 上智 外国語学部レベル・5 分)

上智外英は 80 分・大問 3-4 題。本問は長文 1 題で 25-30 分相当。

【例題】(上智大学 外国語学部 英語学科 入試 典型形式・改題)

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Linguists who study the world's languages have, for several decades, been issuing increasingly urgent warnings. Of the roughly seven thousand languages currently spoken on the planet, more than a third are estimated to be at serious risk of disappearing within the present century. Some have fewer than a hundred living speakers; some are spoken fluently only by the oldest generation in a community; some are taught in no school, written in no newspaper, and used in no government office anywhere in the world. Languages can die quickly, when an epidemic or a forced relocation removes the last speakers in a single generation, but they more often die slowly, through the everyday choices of parents who decide, often reluctantly, that their children will be better off speaking a language with a wider economic and political reach.

The phenomenon is sometimes presented as a simple loss, comparable to the extinction of a biological species. The comparison is suggestive but, taken too literally, can mislead. A language is not, like a wolf or a butterfly, a discrete biological entity; it is a practice maintained by a community, embedded in countless daily acts of speaking and listening. To "lose" a language is to lose, at the same time, the songs that were sung in it, the jokes that worked only in its rhythms, the categories of plant and animal and emotion that it organized differently from its neighbours. What disappears is not so much an object as a way of being together in the world.

It would be a mistake, however, to romanticize this loss. Many of the parents who make the consequential choice to raise their children in a dominant language do so for reasons that an outside observer can only respect: better job prospects, escape from the social stigma that minority languages often attract, easier participation in the political and educational institutions of the state. To insist that they preserve a language they themselves have judged a hindrance to their children's lives is to demand a sacrifice from the most

vulnerable in the name of a cultural preservation whose benefits accrue largely to outsiders — to linguists, to tourists, to the global cosmopolitan imagination.

A more careful framing of the question has begun to emerge in recent scholarship. It distinguishes between language loss as it actually occurs, often as a side-effect of broader inequalities of power and opportunity, and the response that outside observers and policy-makers can legitimately make to it. On this more careful view, what the cultural value of minority languages obliges us to is not the imposition of preservation on reluctant communities, but the more modest task of removing the political and economic pressures that make their abandonment seem necessary in the first place.

Several specific reforms can be derived from this framing. The provision of bilingual schooling, which allows children to acquire competence in the dominant language without surrendering competence in their inherited one, has produced encouraging results in regions ranging from Catalonia to New Zealand. Official recognition of minority languages, including their use in courts, in broadcasting, and on signage, removes some of the practical stigma that has often driven their decline. Documentation and digitization, undertaken in genuine partnership with the speech communities themselves rather than as a kind of intellectual extraction, can ensure that even languages whose number of speakers continues to fall remain available to descendants who may, in time, choose to recover them.

Critics of these efforts argue that they constitute a kind of palliative care for languages whose fundamental position is already lost — that bilingual schooling extends the life of a minority language by a generation rather than indefinitely, and that documentation, however carefully done, captures only the surface of what a living language is. The criticism has force. Yet the alternative — to accept that the abandonment of half the world's languages is simply the price of modernity — has costs that are easy to underestimate. A linguistic landscape reduced to a dozen dominant languages would be a humanity diminished in ways we are not yet equipped to measure.

The deeper point may be that the question is not really about language as such. It is about the conditions under which different ways of being human are allowed to continue, and about the kinds of pressure under which those ways either persist or quietly disappear. Languages are among the most visible signs of that more general question; they are not its whole content.

Q1. According to the first paragraph, how do languages most often die?

- ① Through epidemics that wipe out entire speech communities in a single year.
- ② Through everyday decisions by parents, often reluctantly made, to raise their children in a language with a wider economic and political reach.
- ③ Through deliberate government bans on minority languages.
- ④ Through the natural extinction of the people who speak them.

Q2. Why does the author find the comparison between language loss and biological extinction "suggestive but misleading"?

- ① Because biological species do not actually exist.
- ② Because a language is not a discrete entity like a wolf or butterfly, but a practice maintained by a community and embedded in songs, jokes, and shared categories.
- ③ Because biological extinction has been completely solved by modern conservation.
- ④ Because minority languages are spoken by fewer people than animals.

Q3. Why does the author warn against "romanticizing" the loss of minority languages?

- ① Because all minority languages are inherently inferior.
- ② Because the parents who shift their children to a dominant language often do so for understandable reasons — better jobs, escape from stigma, easier access to institutions — and insisting on preservation demands a sacrifice from the most vulnerable.
- ③ Because tourism revenue depends on language disappearance.
- ④ Because linguists are paid too little for their work.

Q4. What is the "more careful framing" that has begun to emerge in recent scholarship?

- ① The view that all minority languages must be preserved by force regardless of community preferences.
- ② The view that the cultural value of minority languages obliges outsiders not to impose preservation on reluctant communities, but to remove the political and economic pressures that make abandonment seem necessary.
- ③ The view that minority languages have no real cultural value.
- ④ The view that linguists should stop studying endangered languages altogether.

Q5. Which of the following is NOT cited in the fifth paragraph as a specific reform that can be derived from this framing?

- ① Bilingual schooling.
- ② Official recognition of minority languages in courts, broadcasting, and signage.
- ③ Documentation and digitization in genuine partnership with the speech communities.
- ④ Mandatory monolingual education in only the minority language.

Q6. Which of the following best summarizes the author's overall conclusion?

- ① The question is, finally, not really about language as such, but about the conditions under which different ways of being human are allowed to continue; languages are among the most visible signs of this more general question, but not its whole content.
- ② All efforts to preserve minority languages should be abandoned as futile.
- ③ Every child in the world should be required to learn at least one endangered language.
- ④ Linguistic diversity has no measurable value to humanity.

言語消滅 — 単純な損失論を超えて

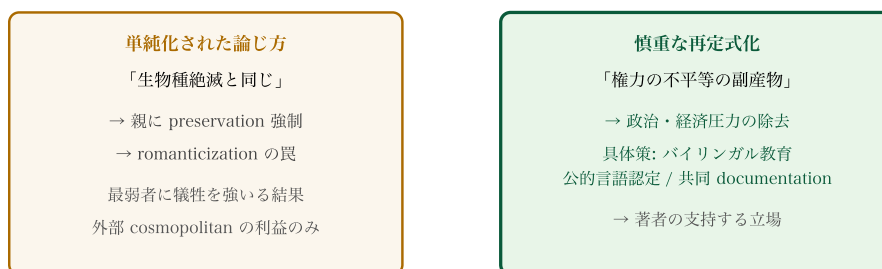


図 1-1 上智外英の核心 — 単純な保存論から「権力構造の修正」への移行

第2章 (解法の全体方針と武器整理・3 分)

外英の長文は「事実提示 → 単純化批判 → 反対側面 → 慎重な再定式化 → 具体策 → 批判 → 一般化」の 7 段論法。

【ジャンル分析】

本文は典型的な (A) sociolinguistics essay (社会言語学エッセイ)。著者は 7 段かけて、言語消滅問題を単純な「保存 vs 進歩」二項対立を超えて再定式化する。(B) 上智外英の長文は言語・文化・グローバル化の交差テーマが頻出。

【本問で必要な 4 つの武器】

- ① (A) 数字データの読み — "seven thousand languages ... a third ... fewer than a hundred speakers"
- ② (B) 比喩への批判 — 第 2 段の "biological extinction" 比喩への精緻化
- ③ (C) 倫理的留保 — 第 3 段 "would be a mistake ... to romanticize"
- ④ (D) 著者の立場 = 慎重な構造修正論者と読む

【各設問の戦略】

Q1 (消滅の仕方) → 第 1 段 "everyday choices of parents ... wider economic and political reach"

Q2 (比喩批判) → 第 2 段 "not, like a wolf or a butterfly, a discrete biological entity"

Q3 (反 romanticize) → 第 3 段 "demand a sacrifice from the most vulnerable"

Q4 (再定式化) → 第 4 段 "remove the political and economic pressures"

Q5 (NOT 設問・具体策) → 第 5 段の bilingual/recognition/documentation リスト

Q6 (全体結論) → 最終段 "not really about language as such"

第3章 (Q1 + Q2 — 消滅の仕方 + 比喩批判・8 分)

「事実 + 比喩への批判」を続けて聞く。

【Q1 設問】 How do languages most often die?

★ 第 1 段の論理

"Languages can die quickly, when an epidemic or a forced relocation removes the last speakers in a single generation, but they more often die slowly, through (A) the everyday choices of parents who decide, often reluctantly, that their children will be better off speaking a language with a wider economic and political reach."

★ Q1 paraphrase

本文 "everyday choices of parents ... reluctantly ... wider economic and political reach"

選択肢② "everyday decisions by parents, often reluctantly made, to raise their children in a language with a wider economic and political reach"

→ 直接対応。

【Q1 正解】 ② Through everyday decisions by parents, often reluctantly made, to raise their children in a language with a wider economic and political reach.

【Q2 設問】 Why does the author find the biological extinction comparison "suggestive but misleading"?

★ 第 2 段の論理

"A language is not, like a wolf or a butterfly, (A) a discrete biological entity; it is (B) a practice maintained by a community, embedded in countless daily acts of speaking and listening."

"To 'lose' a language is to lose, at the same time, the songs that were sung in it, the jokes that worked only in its rhythms, the categories of plant and animal and emotion that it organized differently from its neighbours."

★ Q2 paraphrase

本文 "not ... discrete biological entity ... practice ... songs, jokes, categories"

選択肢② "not a discrete entity like a wolf or butterfly, but a practice maintained by a community and embedded in songs, jokes, and shared categories"

→ 直接対応。

【Q2 正解】 ② Because a language is not a discrete entity like a wolf or butterfly, but a practice maintained by a community and embedded in songs, jokes, and shared categories.

💡 言語学の核心: 言語は「物 (entity)」ではなく「実践 (practice)」。Wittgenstein の言語ゲーム論 / Bourdieu の habitus 論と通底する 20 世紀後半の社会言語学的視座。

第4章 (Q3 + Q4 — 反 romanticize + 再定式化・10 分)

「倫理的留保」と「構造修正論」を続けて聞く。外英エッセイの核心。

【Q3 設問】 Why does the author warn against "romanticizing" the loss?

★ 第 3 段の論理

"Many of the parents who make the consequential choice ... do so for reasons that an outside observer can only respect: (A) better job prospects, escape from the social stigma that minority languages often attract, easier participation in the political and educational institutions of the state."

"To insist that they preserve a language they themselves have judged a hindrance to their children's lives is (B) to demand a sacrifice from the most vulnerable in the name of a cultural preservation whose benefits accrue largely to outsiders."

★ Q3 paraphrase

本文 "better job prospects, escape from stigma, easier participation ... demand a sacrifice from the most vulnerable"

選択肢② "the parents who shift their children to a dominant language often do so for understandable reasons — better jobs, escape from stigma, easier access to institutions — and insisting on preservation demands a sacrifice from the most vulnerable"

→ 直接対応。

【Q3 正解】 ② Because the parents who shift their children to a dominant language often do so for understandable reasons — better jobs, escape from stigma, easier access to institutions — and insisting on preservation demands a sacrifice from the most vulnerable.

【Q4 設問】 What is the "more careful framing" that has begun to emerge?

★ 第 4 段の論理

"It distinguishes between language loss as it actually occurs, often as (A) a side-effect of broader inequalities of power and opportunity, and the response that outside observers and policy-makers can legitimately make to it."

"what the cultural value of minority languages obliges us to is (B) not the imposition of preservation on reluctant communities, but the more modest task of removing the political and economic pressures that make their abandonment seem necessary in the first place."

★ Q4 paraphrase

本文 "not the imposition of preservation ... but ... removing the political and economic pressures"

選択肢② "the cultural value of minority languages obliges outsiders not to impose preservation on reluctant communities, but to remove the political and economic pressures that make abandonment seem necessary"

→ 直接対応。

【Q4 正解】② The view that the cultural value of minority languages obliges outsiders not to impose preservation on reluctant communities, but to remove the political and economic pressures that make abandonment seem necessary.

★ 重要観察 — Q3 と Q4 の連動

Q3 = romanticize の批判 (倫理的留保) → Q4 = 構造修正論 (政策的代替案)。(A) 「単純な保存論ではない、しかし無責任な放置でもない」中道路線が外英エッセイの王道。

言語消滅への 3 立場 — 外英の中道

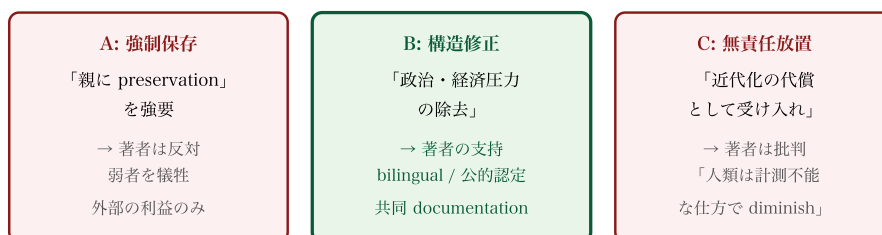


図 5-1 上智外英の中道 — A 強制保存と C 無責任放置の間に B 構造修正

第5章 (Q5 — NOT 設問・具体策・5 分)

第 5 段の 3 具体策リストから外れる選択肢を消去法で。

【設問】 Which of the following is NOT cited as a specific reform that can be derived from this framing?

★ 第 5 段の具体策リスト

- ・ (i) "The provision of (A) bilingual schooling, which allows children to acquire competence in the dominant language without surrendering competence in their inherited one"
- ・ (ii) "(B) Official recognition of minority languages, including their use in courts, in broadcasting, and on signage"
- ・ (iii) "(C) Documentation and digitization, undertaken in genuine partnership with the speech communities themselves rather than as a kind of intellectual extraction"

★ 選択肢と照合

- ・ ① Bilingual schooling → 下線A : ○
- ・ ② Official recognition → 下線A : ○
- ・ ③ Documentation and digitization in partnership → 下線A : ○
- ・ ④ Mandatory monolingual education in only the minority language → (B) 本文と逆方向

★ なぜ ④ が逆方向か

著者は bilingual (二言語) を推奨。「少数言語のみ」の monolingual 教育は親の選択 (dominant language も習得させたい) を否定する強要に他ならない。著者はこのような romanticization を第 3 段で明確に批判。

【正解】 ④ Mandatory monolingual education in only the minority language.

第6章 (Q6 — Main Idea 設問 + 関連話題・10 分)

外英エッセイの結論は「言語問題 = より一般的な問題の visible sign」型。

【設問】 Which of the following best summarizes the author's overall conclusion?

★ 最終段の精読

"The deeper point may be that (A) the question is not really about language as such. It is about (B) the conditions under which different ways of being human are allowed to continue, and about the kinds of pressure under which those ways either persist or quietly disappear. Languages are (C) among the most visible signs of that more general question; they are not its whole content."

→ 主旨 3 要素:

- ①言語問題そのものに尽きない
- ②「異なる人間の生き方が継続する条件」が真の問い
- ③言語は最も可視的な兆候だが全部ではない

★ 選択肢①との対応

"The question is, finally, not really about language as such, but about the conditions under which different ways of being human are allowed to continue; languages are among the most visible signs of this more general question, but not its whole content."

→ 3 要素すべて含む。

【正解】 ① The question is, finally, not really about language as such, but about the conditions under which different ways of being human are allowed to continue; languages are among the most visible signs of this more general question, but not its whole content.

★ 関連話題 — 上智外英進学後への接続

- ・ (A) UNESCO Atlas of the World's Languages in Danger — 公式言語消滅マップ
- ・ (B) David Crystal "Language Death" (2000) — 言語消滅論の代表作
- ・ (C) Ken Hale — MIT 言語学者、消滅言語記録の先駆者
- ・ (D) Suzanne Romaine "Vanishing Voices" — Daniel Nettle との共著
- ・ 日本: アイヌ語 / 八重山言語 / 与那国語 — 国内の endangered languages

★ 上智外英の入試がこのテーマを選ぶ理由

- ・ 外英の核心 = (A) 言語と文化のインターフェイス
- ・ 本問は「グローバル英語の支配 vs ローカル言語の保存」という現代外英の中心問題
- ・ 「単純な賛成 / 反対」ではなく「構造的理解 + 倫理的留保 + 具体的政策」の三位一体を試す

★ 大学進学後への接続

1 年次: 言語学概論・社会言語学・文化人類学

2-3 年次: 多言語社会研究ゼミ / 言語政策ゼミ / 通訳翻訳論

卒論候補: アイヌ語復興運動の政策評価 / 沖縄方言の世代間継承 / バイリンガル教育の比較研究

第7章 (外英英語 攻略のコツ・5 分)

上智外英長文を完答するための 5 つの技術。

【コツ 1】 7 段論法 (事実 → 単純化批判 → 倫理的留保 → 再定式化 → 具体策 → 批判 → 一般化) を予測

外英エッセイは「単純な保存 vs 進歩」を超える中道路線が定番。(A) 第 3 段の "It would be a mistake, however, to romanticize" のような留保節を見たら著者の中道立場の合図。

【コツ 2】 言語学・社会言語学者の固有名詞

- ・ (A) Chomsky / Saussure / Sapir-Whorf — 古典的言語学
- ・ (B) Crystal / Nettle / Romaine — 言語消滅論
- ・ (C) Bourdieu / Habermas — 言語と権力の社会学
- ・ (D) UNESCO / SIL International — 言語政策機関

【コツ 3】 外英頻出語の文脈推測

bilingual / monolingual / stigma / hindrance / documentation / digitization / preservation / endangered / minority / cosmopolitan

【コツ 4】 誤答パターン 4 種 (外英版)

- ・ (A) 単純化: should be preserved at all costs / should be abandoned as futile — 中道結論
- ・ (B) 強要: mandatory / required / must — 著者は communities の選択を尊重
- ・ (C) 価値否定: no measurable value / no real importance — 本文と逆
- ・ (D) 外部視点の押し付け: tourists / linguists の利益のみ語る選択肢

【コツ 5】 時間配分 (上智外英 80 分)

長文には(A) 25-30 分を上限とする。大問数が多いので時間配分要注意。

【最後にひとこと】

上智外英の英語は(A) 語学試験であると同時に(B) 言語学・社会学リテラシー試験。本問の言語消滅論は、入学後に学ぶ社会言語学・言語政策論・多文化社会論の核心テーマ。

第8章 (類題チャレンジ・10 分) [10 点]

本講義の手法を応用する 5 問。

(類題 1) 本文中の "hindrance" の意味として最も近いものを選びなさい。

- ① 障害・妨げ
- ② 助け・援助
- ③ 贈り物
- ④ 祝典

(類題 2) 本文の "intellectual extraction" が示唆するものとして最も適切なものを選びなさい。

- ① 話者コミュニティを無視した一方的な学術的搾取
- ② 鉱物資源の採掘
- ③ 歯科治療
- ④ コンピュータからのデータ抽出

(類題 3) 本文中で "Catalonia" と "New Zealand" が引用される目的として最も適切なものを選びなさい。

- ① バイリンガル教育が成果を挙げた事例として
- ② 言語が完全に消滅した事例として
- ③ 宗教改革の起こった土地として
- ④ オリンピック開催地として

(類題 4) 本文の "palliative care" (緩和ケア) という比喩が示唆するものとして最も適切なものを選びなさい。

- ① 根本的な解決ではなく、衰退の進行を遅らせるだけの対症療法
- ② 完全治癒を目指す積極的治療
- ③ ホスピスでの最期の看取り

④ 予防医学

(類題 5) 本文の論理構成として最も近いものを選びなさい。

① 事実 (7000 言語) → 単純化批判 (生物比喩) → 倫理的留保 (反 romanticize) → 再定式化 (構造修正) → 具体策 → 批判への応答 → 一般化

② 結論先出し → 根拠列挙のみ

③ 賛成意見の単純な列挙

④ 歴史的説明のみで結論なし

第9章 (まとめ・宿題・5 分)

今日の核心整理と上智外英本番に向けた宿題

【本日の核心 5 か条】

- ① 外英エッセイは (A) 単純な「保存 vs 進歩」を超える中道路線 が王道。
- ② (B) 倫理的留保 (反 romanticize) は外英エッセイの定番技法。
- ③ (C) 構造修正論 = 「個人に押し付けない、構造を変える」アプローチ。
- ④ NOT 設問は「(D) 著者が批判した立場の延長」(mandatory monolingual 等) が罠。
- ⑤ 主旨設問は (A) 「言語問題 = より一般的な問題の visible sign」 型を選ぶ。

【宿題】

- ① 本講義の Q1-Q6 を見ないで本文だけ読み直し、自分で 6 問の設問を作成。
- ② 類題 5 問を解き直し、本文 7 段の各段にひと言タイトルを書き出す。
- ③ 過去問: 上智大学 外国語学部 英語 (過去 5 年分) から長文 1 題を選び、本日の手法で精読する。

【次回授業】 上智外英の英作文 (200 words 程度) — "Should the Japanese government do more to support the Ainu language?" の論理構成

【最後にひとこと】

上智外英の英語は (A) 語学試験 であると同時に (B) 言語政策リテラシー試験。本問の言語消滅論は、入学後に学ぶ社会言語学・多文化社会論の核心テーマ。